D-7 VERIFICATION — Sepher Sephiroth §88 "Darkness — ChSK"

Work log and conclusion, 2026-10-11. Scribe's verification for Johnathan's red pen. Findings, never doctrine.

The question

§88 glosses "Darkness" against a ChSK Hebrew word. Two readings:

- **חסך** (chet-samekh-kaf) = 8+60+20 = **88** — valued right, glossed wrong

.(to withhold, spare" — not darkness" = חסך)

- **חשך** (chet-shin-kaf) = 8+300+20 = **328** — glossed right ("darkness"),

valued wrong (not 88).

The shin/samekh ambiguity was unresolved: which letters did Crowley print?

Work log

- **W-1 — Hypothesis:** the 1912 Equinox I:8 scan on Internet Archive will

settle it by eye; samekh (ס, closed circle) and shin (ש, three branches) are visually distinguishable. Method: locate the item (`oto-equinox-vol-1-no-01-10`, complete Vol. I run), pull the No. 8 djvu.xml, find the §88 page object via the "Darkness" gloss, render that PDF page, inspect the glyphs. Observation: OBJECT 327 held the §88 block; PDF p. 328 (supplement p. 14) rendered cleanly. Result: proceed to visual.

- **W-2 — Hypothesis:** a 4× enlargement of the "Darkness" row will resolve

the middle glyph. Method: cropped the row, enlarged, inspected. Observation: the word reads right-to-left **ח-ס-ך** — chet, then an unmistakable closed circle (samekh), then kaf-final with its long descender. No three-branched shin anywhere in the word. Result: **the 1912 print reads חסך (samekh).**

- **W-3 — Hypothesis:** a later reprint may differ. Method: same procedure

on the 1973 Weiser *Qabalah of Aleister Crowley: Three Texts* (open scan, `theqabalahofaleistercrowleythreetexts`; its own description says the Sepher Sephiroth is taken from Equinox I:8). Located §88 at OBJECT 277 → PDF p. 278 (supplement p. 14). Observation: "Darkness" again reads **חסך**, samekh clearly closed-circle. Result: **1973 agrees with 1912.**

- **Dead end:** first rendering pass landed on §126 (אפלה, also glossed

"Darkness") — "Darkness" is used as a gloss more than once in the tables. Taught: match the gloss *a nd* the section number, never the gloss alone.

Conclusion

The print reads חסך (chet-samekh-kaf) = 88 — valued right, glossed wrong — in both the 1912 Equinox I:8 and the 1973 Weiser reprint. The ambiguity is resolved: samekh, not shin, by direct visual inspection of two printings 61 years apart.

Assessment

- This is **not** a Yophiel-class anomaly: there is no numerical

discrepancy — the value 88 is correct for the printed letters. It is a gloss mismatch: "Darkness" belongs to חשך328(, not חסך.

- Most economical reading: an honest shin/samekh slip — Crowley (or his

lexicon work) conflated two similar roots, valuing חסך correctly at 88 while attaching חשך's English gloss. Mundane error, not a blind: it affects no equation and carries no hidden number.

• Printer's error is possible but unprovable; persistence across the

re-typeset 1973 edition does not distinguish, since that edition was set from the 1912 text.

• Note for the ledger: as a "breadcrumb" candidate this scores near zero —

it is evidence of ordinary human fallibility in the tables, which cuts *against* the premise that every anomaly is intentional.

Sources

• 1912: *The Equinox* Vol. I No. 8 (London, Fall 1912), Sepher Sephiroth

supplement p. 14. Scan: https://archive.org/details/oto-equinox-vol-1-no-01-10 (file "Equinox Vol 1 No 08.pdf", PDF p. 328).

• 1973: *The Qabalah of Aleister Crowley: Three Texts* (Weiser),

Sepher Sephiroth p. 14. Scan: https://archive.org/details/theqabalahofaleistercrowleythreetexts (PDF p. 278).

Not verified

• Crowley's manuscript (if extant): both printings could descend from one

manuscript slip — the print agreement does not reach behind the print.

• The 1955 *777 Revised* edition: not checked (the 1973 Weiser served as

the later-edition witness; both agree).

• Whether any period lexicon glosses חסך as "darkness": not exhaustively

checked; the standard lexicons do not.